

RISHABH JAIN

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DATA SCIENTIST | AI ENGINEER | ML ENGINEER | RESEARCH SCIENTIST

I am a Data Scientist, AI Engineer, and ML Engineer with a PhD in AI for Speech from the University of Galway, Ireland. My work focuses on visual speech recognition, multimodal audio-visual AI, speech-to-text, text-to-speech, and large language model-based speech technologies. I have experience developing, evaluating, and benchmarking AI systems that combine audio, visual, and language information to improve robustness, generalization, and human-aligned performance. I am especially interested in building practical AI systems that perform reliably in real-world conditions.

STRENGTHS AND TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Soft skills:

Teamwork, communication, leadership, Research-driven thinking, problem-solving, ethical AI advocacy, and responsible AI.

Languages and ML Libraries:

SQL, R, Python, C, C++, C#, Java, HTML, CSS, NodeJS, Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, Librosa, Transformers, Sklearn, Seaborn, Tensorflow and PyTorch.

Softwares and Cloud Platforms:

Anaconda, Spyder, Jupyter Notebook, VS Code, Eclipse, AWS, GCP, Colab, Docker, Git, Bitbucket, Ollama, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Linux.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Trinity College Dublin, Ireland

Research And Teaching Fellow (Post Doctoral Researcher)

November 2024 - Present

- Working on the Speech Space project to advance **multimodal audio-video speech understanding**, with a focus on robust, human-aligned models that combine visual and acoustic speech cues.
- Developing standardized pipeline for **generalized AVSR** and **lipreading** evaluation across benchmarks, enabling consistent data processing and reproducible experiments.
- Developing and evaluating **LLM-based audio-video speech systems** that integrate visual and acoustic cues for robust speech understanding, with attention to accuracy, reliability, and responsible AI use..
- Exploring evaluation methods that better reflect **human perceptual behavior**, with attention to transparency, fairness, and the limits of benchmark performance.

Trinity College Dublin, Ireland

Teaching Fellow

January 2026 - May 2026

- Designed and delivered an **Advanced AI module** with **lectures, labs, assignments, and assessments** across NLP, computer vision, speech and audio, and efficient fine-tuning.
- Led hands-on notebooks and lab sessions connecting theory to implementation across **transformer architectures**, tokenisation, attention mechanisms, **speech-to-text** and **text-to-speech** systems, multimodal models, and parameter-efficient adaptation, including **BERT, GPT, Vision Transformers, CLIP, Whisper, LoRA, and QLoRA**.
- Supervised student projects across **reinforcement learning, generative AI, multimodal systems, speech** and accessibility, vision, and financial machine learning.

Oxford Wave Research, Oxford, UK

Research Scientist (Contract)

February 2024 - May 2024

- Conduct research on training the models in the domain of **Speech-To-Text** and **LLMs** for low resource languages.
- Working with engineers to train and deploy models for production, and optimizing models for real-world use cases such as improving ASR for low resource **Albanian speech**, which led to improved transcription accuracy by **20%**.
- Proficient in finetuning, and deploying advanced LLMs (eg. Llama, Gemma, Gemini, Command-R, Mistral). Leveraged diverse LLM tools and frameworks such as **Ollama, Langchain, LM Studio and llama.cpp**.
- Creating a pipeline combining **Whisper ASR, speaker diarization, speaker segmentation and LLM summarization**, enhancing model capabilities for nuanced tasks in NLP and NLU for law and forensics use cases, cutting down manual summarisation time by 40%, thereby boosting productivity for legal and forensic professionals.
- Experienced in **LLM Quantization** methodologies, implementing efficient model compression techniques to optimize inference speed and resource utilization while maintaining model fidelity.
- Conducted evaluations of LLMs across multiple linguistic domains, leading to **precise optimizations** that improved model performance, accuracy, and applicability in diverse, real-world tasks critical to legal and forensic analysis.
- Managed and analyzed sensitive **forensic speech data**, including law enforcement and criminal data, ensuring responsible and ethical AI deployment in forensic investigations.
- Developed models and methodologies to detect and mitigate **deep fakes**, ensuring the integrity and reliability of AI applications in forensic and legal contexts.

- Designed and deployed **edge AI models (STT and TTS)** in collaboration with Xperi, significantly enhancing child-user experience by enabling seamless real-time speech interaction in the DAVID smart-toy.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including engineers, linguists, and product managers from Xperi Ireland and Xperi USA for **optimising AI models** and **deployment** in production environment.
- Developed new methodologies for ethical and responsible **data collection** and **annotation** of **child speech** (automatic labelling), addressing challenges like data scarcity and noise, improving the robustness of child speech ASR and TTS models.
- Developed **synthetic child speech datasets**, resulting in a 5-10% increase in the accuracy of **child ASR systems**.
- Implemented **data anonymisation techniques** for child speech datasets, enhancing privacy protections and ensuring compliance with stringent ethical standards and regulations.

- Project: DTIF-DAVID, Aim: Development of a **multimodal (sound and vision)** AI processing platform with **low cost** and **low power** consumption to be used for the creation of voice-enabled toys.
- Conduct a comprehensive review of existing research and literature related to **child speech technologies (ASR/TTS)**.
- Developed methodologies for **ASR** and **TTS** with child speech, from training to evaluation of models, resulting in synthetic speech datasets that upheld privacy standards and **GDPR** standards, which also led to the creation of open-source resources and speaker recognition models tailored for various accents in English, spoken by children.
- Developing applications for **speech data collection**, creating methodologies for **data annotations** and **cleaning**.
- Attending conferences, workshops, seminars, and knowledge-sharing activities within research community.
- Documentations of research, preparing reports/presentations and contributing towards **novel publications**.
- Setting up and managing distributed training pipelines (leveraging multiple GPUs), coordinating data preprocessing and augmentation, monitoring training progress, and evaluating model performance using appropriate metrics.
- Led the adaptation of **Whisper** models to better recognize child speech, achieving between **20% - 50% improvement** in accuracy over different child speech datasets.
- Collaborated with Data Protection Officers (DPOs) to ensure the **ethical collection** and use of child speech data.
- Helped shape **data collection** and **compliance practices** to ensure privacy-conscious, responsible handling, and risk-aware use of child speech data.

EDUCATION

PUBLICATION AND CONFERENCES

Publications:

- R. Jain** and N. Harte, "From Hype to Insight: Rethinking Large Language Model Integration in Visual Speech Recognition," **ICASSP 2026** , Barcelona, Spain, 2026, pp. 18717-18721, doi: 10.1109/ICASSP55912.2026.11464703.
- R. Jain**, A. Barcovschi, M. Y. Yiwere, D. Bigioi, P. Corcoran and H. Cucu, "A WAV2VEC2-Based Experimental Study on Self-Supervised Learning Methods to Improve Child Speech Recognition," in **IEEE Access**, vol. 11, pp. 46938-46948, 2023, doi: 10.1109/ACCESS.2023.3275106.
- Jain, R.**, Barcovschi, A., Yiwere, M., Corcoran, P., Cucu, H. (2023) Adaptation of Whisper models to child speech recognition. Proc. **INTERSPEECH 2023**, 5242-5246, doi: 10.21437/Interspeech.2023-935

Conferences:

- Presented at Interspeech 2023, ICASSP 2026, and IEEE Region 8 SYP Congress (Tunis, Tunisia) as Chair, representing the University of Galway Student Branch.
- Organised a special session on Child Speech Technologies at the SpeD 2023 Conference, Bucharest, Romania
- Served as a reviewer for Interspeech, ICASSP, ASRU, Computer Speech & Language, IEEE Access, IMVIP, and SpeD.

REFERENCES

- Dr. Anil Alexander, CEO, Oxford Wave Research, Oxford, UK, anil@oxfordwaveresearch.com
- Dr. Peter Corcoran, IEEE fellow, Professor at the University of Galway, Lead PI in DAVID, HELIUS and d-real projects, peter.corcoran@universityofgalway.ie
- Dr. Gabriel Costache, VP of Machine Learning at Fotonation, gabriel.costache@fotonation.com